

Kuzey Koç

+90 542 393 7991 — kuzey.koc@tutamail.com — [linkedin.com/in/kuzeykoc](https://www.linkedin.com/in/kuzeykoc) — savolla.github.io —
youtube.com/@savollaross — Kocaeli, TR

Summary

DevOps and Site Reliability Engineer currently leading infrastructure for Hopi, one of Turkey's largest loyalty and fintech super-apps, managing 20+ microservices across a 30-node GKE production cluster on Google Cloud Platform. Built on a foundation of on-premises Linux systems and network administration at Gravity Robotics, where infrastructure was designed, cabled, and operated from bare metal up as part of a TUBITAK-funded industrial robotics project. Started a career in tech as a STEM Instructor – a thread that still runs through everything: publishes practitioner-level DevOps tutorials on YouTube and maintains a technical blog, because understanding something well enough to teach it is the only kind of understanding worth having.

Technical Skills

Cloud Platforms: Google Cloud Platform (GCP) – GKE, Cloud SQL, Pub/Sub, Cloud Storage, IAM, VPC; Amazon Web Services (AWS)

Container Orchestration: Kubernetes (K8s), OpenShift, Helm, Kustomize, Docker

CI/CD and GitOps: Jenkins, ArgoCD, GitOps workflows

Monitoring and Observability: Prometheus, Grafana, alerting and on-call pipelines

Databases and Messaging: MySQL, MySQL NDB Cluster, Cassandra, PostgreSQL, Redis, Cloud SQL, RabbitMQ

Virtualization and Infrastructure: Terraform, Proxmox VE, KVM, VirtualBox, Vagrant

Programming and Scripting: Python, Bash, C, C++, SQL

Tooling: Git, Tmux, Emacs, Vim, LaTeX, Confluence

Experience

Lead DevOps Engineer / Site Reliability Engineer (SRE) – Hopi

Jun 2025 – Present

Kartaca

Istanbul, TR

- Own the full infrastructure lifecycle for Hopi (hopi.com.tr), a large-scale loyalty and fintech super-app serving millions of users on iOS and Android, hosted on a GKE cluster spanning 30 production nodes across 4 environments (production, staging, test, pretest).
- Manage and operate 20+ microservices in production, maintaining a weekly deployment cadence with zero unplanned downtime as a 2-person DevOps team.
- Administer and optimize GCP-managed data services including Cloud SQL (PostgreSQL and MySQL), Pub/Sub event streaming, Cloud Storage, and VPC networking, keeping p99 query latency within defined SLOs.
- Design and maintain Helm-based release pipelines and Kustomize overlays across all 4 environments, standardizing deployments for a cross-functional team of 10+ engineers.
- Lead on-call rotation and production incident response; define SLOs and SLIs and build Prometheus and Grafana dashboards and alerting rules to proactively surface availability and latency regressions.
- Manage Cassandra and Redis clusters powering Hopi's loyalty engine and session caching layer, performing capacity planning and tuning for high-throughput workloads.

Research and Development Engineer (Intern promoted to Full-time)

Jun 2021 – Jun 2024

Gravity Robotics

Kocaeli, TR

- Contributed to a TUBITAK-funded research project developing a 9-axis industrial arc welding robot for shipbuilding applications, mounted on an X-Y gantry system and running entirely on Linux.
- Built and maintained the on-premises network infrastructure for the robotics lab, including switch configuration, static IP allocation, and local DNS – providing a stable environment for robot-to-server communication.
- Administered Linux servers hosting the trajectory computation backend, handling OS provisioning, service management (systemd), log monitoring, and routine maintenance across the lab environment.
- Built custom Linux images for embedded robot controllers using Buildroot, cross-compiling for target hardware and optimizing the system footprint for real-time operation.
- Developed backend services in Python Flask and C++ using ROS and MoveIt for robot trajectory calculations, applying Forward and Inverse Kinematics to generate motion paths for the welding arm.
- Managed a self-hosted Kubernetes cluster used to deploy and run backend computation services on-premises, operating workload scheduling, resource management, and rolling updates.

STEM Instructor (Part-time)

Spectre Robotics

Feb 2019 – Sep 2019

Düzce, TR

- Designed and delivered technology education programmes for children and young adults covering Linux fundamentals, SQL and databases, basic networking, and hands-on electronics with Arduino and Raspberry Pi.
- Developed structured curricula from scratch for non-technical audiences, strengthening written communication, lesson planning, and technical mentoring skills.

Education

Düzce University

Bachelor of Science in Computer Engineering

Düzce, TR

Aug 2019 – May 2025

- Studies suspended 2021–2023 to pursue full-time industry role at Gravity Robotics.

Projects

NixOS Home Lab – Self-Managed Infrastructure Environment

Late 2024 – Present

Proxmox VE, Kubernetes, Terraform, NixOS

- Operate a Proxmox-based home lab running a self-managed Kubernetes cluster and multiple NixOS virtual machines, provisioned entirely through Terraform and Nix – mirroring production infrastructure practices with no snowflake servers and no manual configuration.
- Serves as the development and testing ground for CI/CD pipeline designs and infrastructure patterns published on YouTube and the technical blog.

Legolas – Personal DevOps Command Automation Framework

Jun 2025 – Present

Python, fzf, YAML, Shell

- Built a CLI tool that turns YAML-defined command recipes into interactive, parameter-driven workflows using fzf – eliminating repetitive kubectl, Helm, and shell commands from daily SRE operations.
- Each recipe declares its parameters, how to populate them (live kubectl output, shell commands, or free input), and a composable output template – keeping operational knowledge reusable, versioned, and shareable across the team.

Technical Writing and Community

DevOps Content Creator and Technical Blogger

May 2025 – Present

youtube.com/@savollaross/videos — savolla.github.io

- Produce practitioner-level video series on niche infrastructure topics including NixOS-based Kubernetes cluster setup, Terraform on Proxmox, and end-to-end CI/CD pipeline design; all content is hands-on verified against the home lab environment.
- Maintain a technical blog with 10–15 long-form posts on Linux internals, Kubernetes operations, and infrastructure automation – written to be immediately actionable for other engineers.

Certifications

EF SET English Certificate – B2 Upper Intermediate (52/100)